Sweet Senses and Sins



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To my beloved Cutie boo.

Prologue

I wanted to write a story.

A short one that feels like watching an intense movie. Where the character is so interesting that you never get bored, and fifty thousand colours, movements and face expressions unveil at all moments in time.

But instead I wrote this.

A series of short ones that feels like smelling a field of lilies. First you see them, and you have time to imagine and prepare while admiring their beauty. Then you hear the wind shudder and see them dancing on their single little leg. Finally the wind brings their scent to your nose, and memories flow into your mind.

1
Perceptive feelings

The sound of running

Running. Your AirPods are dead, and you hear two things: the low-pitched stomps your soft new running shoes make when they hit the cold, hard asphalt, and the deep breaths you try to keep at regular intervals. The first is your goal, and the second is how you make it work. Both are loud and clear, to you but not to the other people, who keep cutting you off by suddenly changing their paths so they can take a picture of a big water fountain. I had never heard my own breathing before. No one told me I had

one. And only when I realized that could I hear our four footsteps.

A misconception of light

Light is made of photons. At least, that is what I was taught in high school. Then I went to university, and they told me that light was also a wave. They taught me how to calculate it and predict where it would go, what color it would be, and how much energy it has. I thought I knew most things about light.

Paintings are big liars. They can make you think that light is coming from an angle when, physically, it is not. They can make you think that a color is red when it is made only of green pigments. Paintings blatantly trick your eyes, and that is what makes them beautiful. That was the first time I thought I actually knew nothing about light.

Then you came in. And light was the morning sun on your blurry silhouette when you got out of bed. Light was slower than your mind whenever anything mattered. Light has the shape of your smile and the color of your laugh. Light was brighter than the sun on the night you asked me.

The taste of life

Having taste and tasting have completely different meanings. Tasting holds the foolishness of reckless curiosity, driven by an open-ended expansion of our space of experiences. That space is then carefully filtered through unplanned situations, and the selection is judged by random people whose approval absolutely no one needs, until it becomes so-called “having taste.” I don’t believe in “having taste.” It is reductionism applied to having an

evolving personality, to having exploding desires to fulfill, to having control over your feelings, to having experiences to share or to keep, and to having relationships with people who also have all of these things.

And that's why you can like and dislike so many things, that's why you are always eager for good food, and that is also why I want to be part of your taste.

The smell of good memories

It is anosmically* obvious that your olfactory power is far greater than that of the common *Homo sapiens* of modern society. It is also commonly accepted that smells have strong associative power when it comes to episodic memory, and the main reason for that seems to be their

relationship with emotions. So it got me wondering: what do your good memories smell like?

Could you smell the grape-derived aromas when we went on the wine bike tour? Does love smell different when it's queer? Does the smell of Aperol Spritz remind you more of a wedding in Germany or a wedding in Italy? What was the smell of our first kiss?

**Anosmic: someone who cannot smell, a condition also called smell blindness.*

A touch of something

Like a force of nature
All you touch becomes gold
Using physics' legislature
And then my heart was sold

For all the moments I cried
And you embraced my soul
There is nothing but pride
In having this hand to hold

From the softness of your skin
To the warmth of your chest
All the feelings from within
So with you I can rest

2
Seven lovely sins

Gula (gluttony)

It only takes one bite to be conquered. After two bites, I started to understand how the intricate taste touches every region of your mouth and selectively presses on your taste receptors. On the third bite, I saw pictures of exotic places you have never been to, brought to life through a deep history that refined the taste before it reached your palate. On the fourth bite, I questioned reality, as if there were a new rule to the game, a new color to see with eyes you didn't know you had. On the nineteenth bite, I was already full, but I looked forward to the twentieth one. On the second day, I made sure to leave work

early so I could have dinner with you again. In the third year, I thought only talent could describe this experience, but it might just be the right proportions of understanding of the world, care, and love.

Fornicatio (lust)

Out of the silence, what stood out were the peculiar songs of birds we had never seen, and the heavy presence of fallen civilizations with uncanny ball games and erudite stone carvers. As you walked up the large stone stairs facing precisely west, the sun slowly shied away behind the clouds and let you glow like a long-forgotten deity the Maya might have prayed to. And under the arch, you came to me and held my hand very tight. The shivers already told me that I was, and would be, blessed for a little longer.

fornicate. Verb
for·ni·cate ˈfȯr-nə-ˌkāt
intransitive verb
: to engage in consensual sexual intercourse with someone to whom one is not married
from Latin fornix, originally "arch, vaulted chamber, a vaulted opening, a covered way”.

Avaritia (greed)

More
Magnificent Orchestras of Radiant Emotions
More
Methodical Openings of Right-hearted Exchange
More

Magical Oven-baked Rhabarber Erdbeerkuchen

More
Memorable Original and Romantic Expeditions
More
Mellow and Open-hearted Roosting Embraces
More

Acedia (sloth)



Ira (wrath)

If you count the number of seconds between the moment you see lightning and the moment you hear thunder, then divide that number by 3, you get the approximate distance of the lightning strike in km. This is because sound travels at about 340 meters per second, and light is almost infinitely faster.

However, according to Einstein's theory of relativity, there is a way to be faster than light, and, much like lightning, it requires precise conditions. The main predicates of the theory of relativity lie in extreme scales of distance and of relative motion between the object and the observer.

In this paper, I will prove to you how Cutie boo's mind can overcome the neurological constraints of the

human being. We can model the speed of Cutie boo's mind with the following function:

$$mental\ speed = f(mental\ capacity)$$

where mental capacity represents the number of connections in Cutie boo's brain, and f represents the mechanical constraints of the brain's structure. However, this function is written in the subject's frame of reference, and an additional term is needed from the perspective of an external observer. We can therefore define:

$$mental\ speed_{observer} = f(mental\ capacity) + g(referential\ distance)$$

Most of the time, the referential distance, also called "spiritual distance," is negligible, and therefore all human mental capacities converge towards a maximum value, just like the speed of light. Since we have

empirical evidence that Cutie boo's brain is much faster than maximum, we fitted our model to the data and found that the distance required in the additional term is comparable to the distance between the mortal world and Olympus (see old papers on Greek mythology). This may be sufficient evidence to suggest that Cutie boo shares a high degree of proximity with high-ranking gods. This concludes my research on how Cutie boo's mind can exceed regular mental capacities. In future work, we will discuss the curious reasons why Cutie boo chose to stay with Cutie bun a little bit longer.

Invidia (envy)

Dear Cutie boo,

As I write these words, you are writing your thesis. Since I don't regularly post about my life on social media, I thought

it was of the utmost importance to send you this letter, so that you know I am the happiest person on the planet. Here are the main reasons why:

First, I wake up every day in the arms of the softest person in the world.

Second, every single time I am down, I am cared for in the most wonderful way.

Third, I have felt accepted, understood and loved every single day for the past three, almost four, years.

Fourth, my partner loves cats as much as I do. And finally, I get to fall asleep in the arms of the most amazing and beautiful creature in the world. I bet this makes you a little envious of the life I've been leading.

I wish you a good continuation,

Sincerely,

Cutie bun

Superbia (pride)

Stigmatized as a sin, pride seems to be the most controversial one to write about. Pride is a combination of self-acceptance, self-love, strength in all situations, bravery, and the stubborn refusal to make yourself smaller so that others feel more comfortable. Somewhere along the way, someone decided that this was arrogance. But that someone had probably never had to fight for the right to hold a hand in the street.

Pride is also a parade. It is music too loud, glitter that stays in your hair for a week, and strangers who hug you because, for one day, everyone is family. It is walking in the open, in the middle of the road, after years of walking in the shadows.

But the pride I want to write about is quieter. It is the one I feel when you

explain your research and the room goes silent. It is the one I feel when you jump first to help someone, when you get back up after a bad day. It is the one I feel every time someone asks me who you are, and I get to answer: “That’s my partner.”

If this is a sin, then I am a terrible sinner. And I have no intention of repenting.

Epilogue

This little adventure has already come to an end. As you can imagine, it took me a long time to write. I went back and forth, constantly thinking that no word was good enough to qualify you and all the happiness you bring into my life every day. I wish you a happy 33rd birthday, and I love you.

This could have been a personalized mug or a scented candle, but you deserve so much more.